

Product requirements document (PRD)

Describe the data product from the point of view of the people who will use it: who they are, what they get, how good and how fresh it must be, and how we will know it is working. The data team turns your answers into a design, then explains that design back to you in plain words for your signature before anything is built.

Use the PRD or the BRD (4a), not both. They feed the design in the same way.

Use case
Define 1 · Describe it

Scorecard
Define 2 · Score it

Prioritisation
Define 3 · Choose

BRD or PRD
Define 4 · Require it

TDD
Design · Next stage

How to fill this in

- Use business terms. Do not name technologies or modelling techniques; the data team chooses those in the design.
- Give every requirement at least one worked example of a correct answer.
- If something is not decided yet, add it to Open questions with an owner and a due date. Do not guess.

PRD ID

For example PRD-SALES-002

DATA PRODUCT

PRODUCT OWNER

DATA STEWARD

BUSINESS DOMAIN

USE CASE

The approved use case, for example UC-SALES-001

VERSION

0.1.0

DATE

STATUS

☐ Draft

☐ In review

☐ Approved

Change history

Version	What changed	Raised by	Accepted by

1

Product summary

Product statement

For [consumers] who need to [job], [product] provides [what], so that [outcome].

Problem it solves

What is hard or impossible today?

Why now

Which benefits from the approved use case does it deliver?

2 Consumers and their questions

Who will use the product, which questions must it answer for them, and which decisions do the answers support?

ID	Consumer group	Question they need answered	Decision it supports	How often
BQ-1				
BQ-2				
BQ-3				
BQ-4				

3 What the product provides

What do consumers receive: a dashboard, report, extract, API or dataset? Which figures, broken down by what, and which details?

ID	Type	Figures	Broken down by	Details shown	For whom, how often	Req. IDs
OUT-1						
OUT-2						
OUT-3						
OUT-4						

4 Data definitions and rules

How detailed the data is, how it behaves when values change, and how exceptions are handled.

Finest level of detail

What is the finest level consumers need to drill down to? For example "an individual line on a customer order".

What makes each one distinct

Could two records ever describe the same thing? If so, which one counts?

When values change

If a value such as a customer's segment changes, should past figures follow the change or stay as they were?

ID	What can change	Should past figures follow the change or stay as they were? Why?
HB-1		
HB-2		
HB-3		

Exceptions

What should happen with cancellations, refunds, amendments and late corrections? One per line.

Agreement with other teams

Must these figures agree with another team's figures?

ID	Team	Must agree on
AG-1		
AG-2		

Can be added up across

For example days, months, regions and categories.

5 Service levels**Freshness**

How up to date must the product be? For example "hourly during the working day".

Why

Which decision depends on that freshness? What goes wrong if the product is late?

Availability

When must the product be available? For example "08:00 to 18:00, Monday to Friday".

Users

Roughly how many people will use it, and how often?

Volume

Roughly how many records arrive on a busy day?

Support

Who do consumers contact when something looks wrong, and how fast must they get an answer?

6 Quality expectations**Unusable record**

What would make a record unusable to consumers?

When bad data arrives

- ☐ Stop and alert - do not publish
- ☐ Publish the good records and report the bad ones
- ☐ Publish everything and flag the bad records

7 Sources

Which systems do you believe hold this data, and which one is the authority?

System	What it holds	Is it the authority?

8 Access, protection and sharing**Sensitivity**

Your organisation's classification, for example Internal or Confidential.

Where the data must stay

A country or jurisdiction, for example "United States".

Details some consumers must not see

For example customer contact details.

What those consumers may still see

Who may use the product

Consumers outside the organisation

Does anyone outside the organisation need the product? Who, and how may they receive it?

9 Requirements and acceptance examples

One requirement for each behaviour consumers need, written as "Users SHALL ..." or "The product SHALL ...". Give at least one worked example of a correct answer: GIVEN a situation, WHEN someone does something, THEN what they should see.

REQUIREMENT

R-1

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-1

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-2

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-2

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-3

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-3

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-4

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-4

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-5

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-5

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-6

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-6

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-7

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-7

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

REQUIREMENT

R-8

ACCEPTANCE
EXAMPLE

AX-8

GIVEN

WHEN

THEN

AND

10 Success measures

How will we know the product works? Link each measure to a benefit in the use case.

Measure	Today	Target	By when	Use-case benefit it proves

11 Releases

What comes in the first release, and what can wait? Refer to requirement IDs.

Release	What it includes (requirement IDs)	Target date

12 Dependencies and risks

What does the product depend on, and what could stop or delay it?

Dependency or risk	Impact if it happens	What we will do	Owner

13 Out of scope

What is explicitly out of scope? Saying so now avoids surprises later.

14 Open questions

Anything not yet decided. Give each question an owner and a due date, and say what we assume if work starts before it is answered.

ID	Question	Owner	Due	What we assume meanwhile	What it affects
OQ-1					
OQ-2					
OQ-3					

Approval

The product owner approves the PRD. Teams whose figures must agree with these (see Data definitions and rules) should sign too.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Product owner			
Data steward			

Next: The data team records the approved PRD in the repository and checks it is complete (gate G0). They then write the technical design (TDD) and explain it back to you in plain words. You sign that explanation before anything is built (gate G1).

For the data team: where each answer goes

Record the approved document in the repository with the `author-brd` skill, as `openspec/specs/products/<domain>/<product>/brd/spec.md` and `brd.yaml`. Put the use case on the Purpose line, for example `**Use case:** UC-SALES-001`. Then run `dpf brd validate <product>` (gate G0) and take any gaps back to the business.

A PRD is recorded in the same place as a BRD, because both answer the same rubric. Keep the number: `PRD-SALES-003` is recorded as `BRD-SALES-003`, and the Purpose line names the source document, for example `**Source:** PRD-SALES-003 v1.0.0`. Product summary, success measures, releases and risks stay with the PRD.

Section	Rubric group	Recorded in
Change history	-	<code>brd.yaml: changelog</code>
1. Product summary	-	<code>spec.md: Purpose</code>
2. Consumers and their questions	A	<code>brd.yaml: business_questions</code>
3. What the product provides	B	<code>brd.yaml: required_outputs</code>
4. Data definitions and rules	C, D, F	<code>brd.yaml: level_of_detail, history_behaviour, exceptions, agreement_with_other_teams, totalling</code>
5. Service levels	E	<code>brd.yaml: timeliness</code>
6. Quality expectations	G	<code>brd.yaml: fitness</code>
7. Sources	H	<code>brd.yaml: sources_believed</code>
8. Access, protection and sharing	I	<code>brd.yaml: sensitivity, residency, protection, external_readers</code>
9. Requirements and acceptance examples	J	<code>spec.md: one Requirement per R-n, one Scenario per AX-n</code>
10. Success measures	-	Kept with the PRD; monitored after go-live
11. Releases	-	Kept with the PRD; later releases become OpenSpec changes
12. Dependencies and risks	-	Kept with the PRD; feasibility findings return here
13. Out of scope	K	<code>brd.yaml: non_goals; spec.md: Scope</code>
14. Open questions	-	<code>brd.yaml: open_questions; spec.md: Open questions</code>